



ESSENTIAL

Don't give your landlord an excuse to make a deduction from your security deposit when you move. If the apartment isn't clean or you leave things behind for the landlord to get rid of, he will charge you for the cost of cleaning or removal and deduct it from your deposit.

Clean the apartment thoroughly before you move out and repair any damage you caused. Remove all of your belongings and any trash. Ask your landlord to walk through the apartment with you and give you a signed statement about the condition you left it in. You may even want to take pictures of the condition of the apartment before you leave, in case you have to go to small claims court to get your security deposit back. Be sure to leave your landlord your forwarding address so he can mail your deposit.

Pet Deposits

If you find an apartment that allows pets, you may be required to pay a pet deposit in addition to your security deposit, to protect the property owner against any damages your pet may cause. Pet deposits can range from \$100 to a full month's rent, and are often nonrefundable or only partially refundable.



ALERT

[Rentlaw.com](http://www.rentlaw.com) (www.rentlaw.com) has links to each state's laws governing rental housing, information about tenants' rights and landlords' obligations, and articles with advice and information about many aspects of moving. Check out the laws in your state before you sign a lease.
